

UPSC CIVIL SERVICES EXAMINATION



INDIAN POLITY

INTRODUCTION

INDIAN POLITY FOR PRELIMS, MAINS, INTERVIEW AND BEYOND.....

The Indian Polity as everybody knows is an important subject for Prelims, Mains and also Interview.



INDIAN
ADMINISTRATIVE SERVICES

SIGNIFICANCE OF THE WORD “BEYOND”?!?

- 1 The significance of the subject is carried forward even when you get into the service. It forms an important part of administration.
- 2 Since it involves not just static portion but also dynamic issues like rights-based issues, political events of constitutional significance, public policy related issues it is not just important for a Civil Service Aspirant or an acting Civil Servant.

SIGNIFICANCE OF THE WORD “BEYOND”?!?



3 To put it pragmatically, it is important for every **INDIAN CITIZEN** to understand what is going on around him, how he is being governed and most importantly his rights and duties!

4 This subject, thus, will help everyone to take **INFORMED DECISIONS**! It also helps in holding the Government accountable for failing to serve its people.

5 This is what makes Polity interesting and enjoyable. Henceforth, we recommend Polity to be read, not only as a civil service aspirant, but as a **RESPONSIBLE CITIZEN** of our country !!

QUICK ANALYSIS OF PRELIMS PAPER AND COMPREHENDING EMERGING TRENDS

Let us look at some of the questions asked in UPSC Prelims 2017

- 1. One of the implications of equality in society is the absence of:**
 - (a) Privileges
 - (b) Restraints
 - (c) Competition
 - (d) Ideology
- 2. Democracy's superior virtue lies in the fact that it calls into activity**
 - a) the intelligence and character of ordinary men and women
 - b) the methods for strengthening executive leadership
 - c) a superior individual with dynamism and vision
 - d) a band of dedicated party workers.

WHAT DOES THE ABOVE QUESTIONS SIGNIFY?

QUICK ANALYSIS OF PRELIMS PAPER AND COMPREHENDING EMERGING TRENDS

It signifies the following things:

1. UPSC is grinding more on the basic understanding and the conceptual clarity of the subject.
2. UPSC gives as much importance for the dynamic part as for the static part. Check out the question below for one of static portion related question.

Consider the following statements:

1. No criminal proceedings shall be instituted against the Governor of a State any court during his term of office.
2. The emoluments and allowances of the Governor of a State shall not be diminished during his term of office.

Which of the above is / are correct?

- | | |
|---------------|--------------------|
| a) 1 only | b) 2 only |
| c) Both 1 & 2 | d) Neither 1 nor 2 |

QUICK ANALYSIS OF PRELIMS PAPER AND COMPREHENDING EMERGING TRENDS

It signifies the following things (contd.):

3. Read between the lines and look for the nuances of the subject.

3. With reference to the Parliament of India, which of the following Parliamentary Committees scrutinizes and reports to the House whether the powers to make regulations, rules, sub-rules, by-laws, etc. conferred by the Constitution or delegated by the Parliament are being properly exercised by the Executive within the scope of such delegation ?

- a) Committee on Government Assurances
- b) Committee on Subordinate Legislation
- c) Rules Committee
- d) Business Advisory Committee

QUICK ANALYSIS OF PRELIMS PAPER AND COMPREHENDING EMERGING TRENDS

It signifies the following things (contd...):

4. Polity is not just polity anymore. It includes **Post-Independence Consolidation** as well.
P.S. Check out for tricks of elimination as in this question!

Consider the following statements :

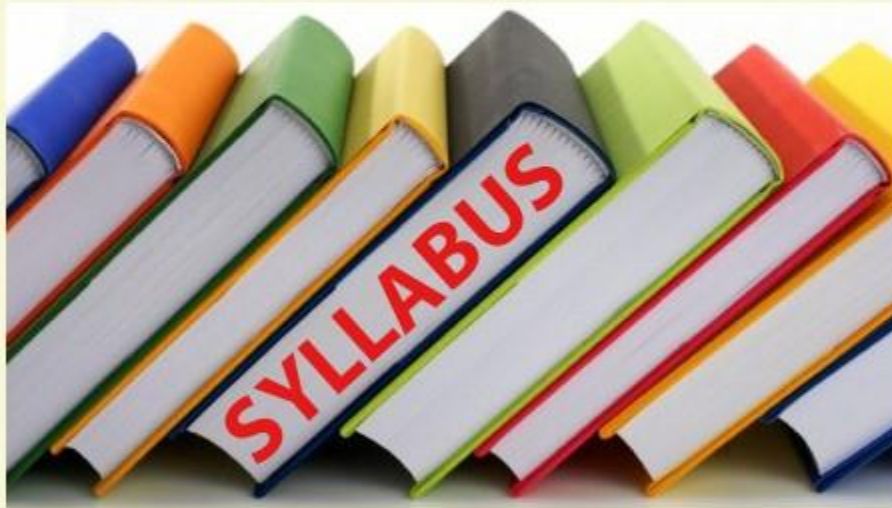
1. In the first Lok Sabha, the single largest party in the opposition was the Swatantra Party.
2. In the Lok Sabha, a “Leader of the Opposition” was recognized for the first time in 1969.
3. In the Lok Sabha, if a party does not have a minimum of 75 members, its leader cannot be recognized as the Leader of the Opposition.

Which of the above is / are correct?

- | | |
|---------------|-----------------|
| a) 1 & 3 only | b) 2 only |
| c) 2 & 3 only | d) All 1, 2 & 3 |

INDIAN POLITY

SYLLABUS OF PRELIMS



INDIAN POLITY AND GOVERNANCE

- 1 Constitution
- 2 Political System
- 3 Panchayati Raj
- 4 Public Policy
- 5 Rights Issues

SYLLABUS OF MAINS- GS PAPER-II

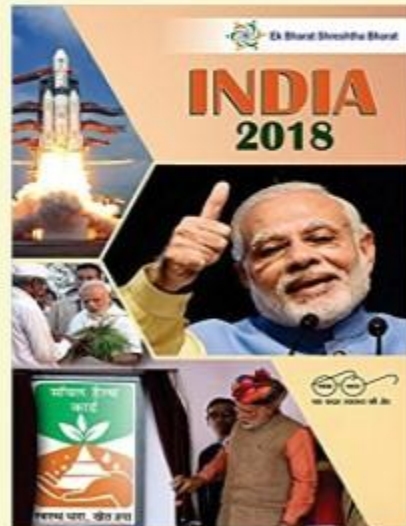
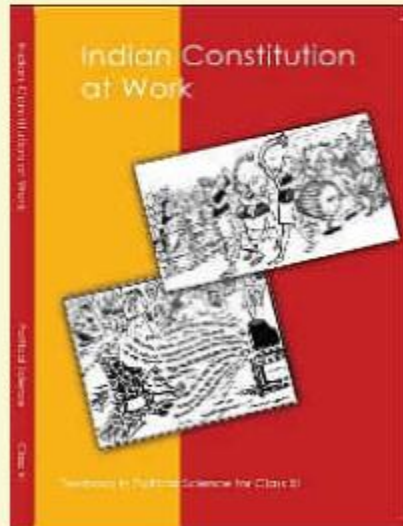
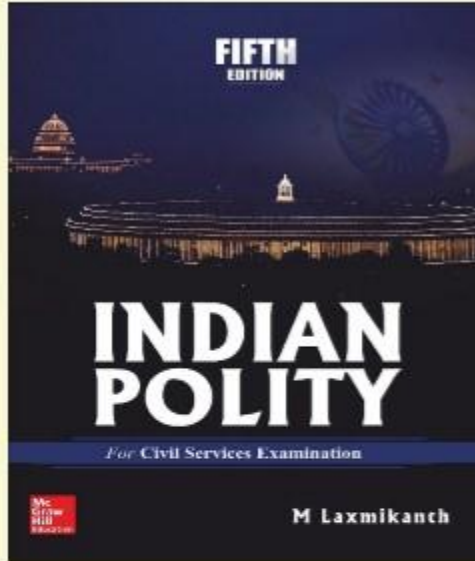


- 1** Indian Constitution- historical underpinnings, evolution, features, amendments, significant provisions and basic structure.
- 2** Functions and responsibilities of the Union and the States, issues and challenges pertaining to the federal structure, devolution of powers and finances up to local levels and challenges therein.
- 3** Separation of powers between various organs; dispute redressal mechanisms and institutions.

SYLLABUS OF MAINS- GS PAPER-II

- 4** Comparison of the Indian constitutional scheme with that of other countries; Parliament and State Legislatures - structure, functioning, conduct of business, powers & privileges and issues arising out of these.
- 5** Structure, organization and functioning of the Executive and the Judiciary Ministries and Departments of the Government; pressure groups and formal/informal associations and their role in the Polity.
- 6** Salient features of the Representation of People's Act.
- 7** Appointment to various Constitutional posts, powers, functions and responsibilities of various Constitutional Bodies.
- 8** Statutory, regulatory and various quasi-judicial bodies.

INDIAN POLITY



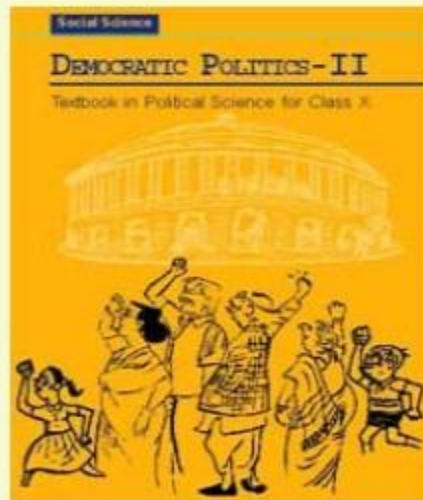
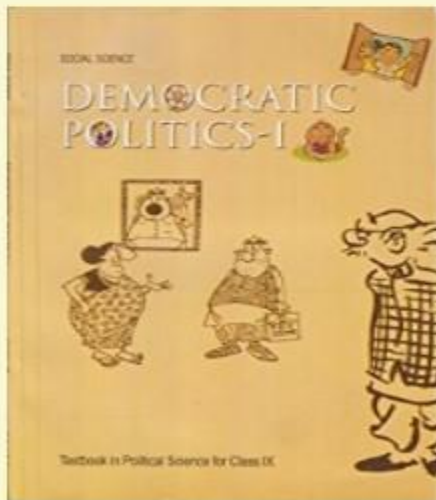
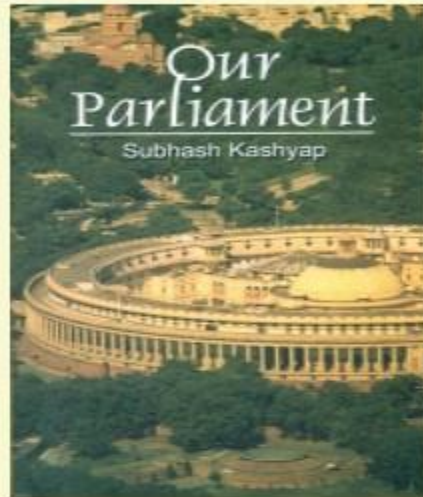
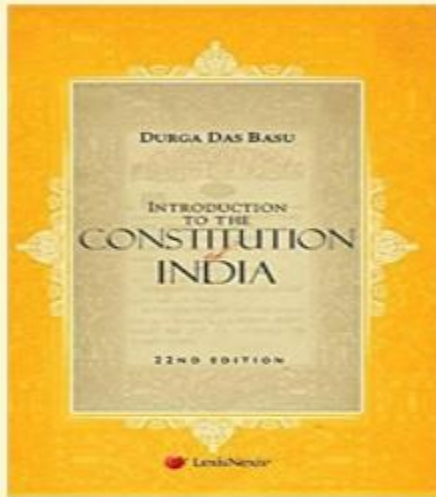
SOURCES TO READ

“MUST-READ” BOOKS – FOR STATIC THEORY

- 1 CLASS XI NCERT INDIAN CONSTITUTION AT WORK
- 2 INDIAN POLITY BY LAXMIKANTH
- 3 INDIA YEAR BOOK 2019 CHAPTERS LIKE NATIONAL SYMBOLS, POLITY (Selective Reading).

INDIAN POLITY

SOURCES TO READ

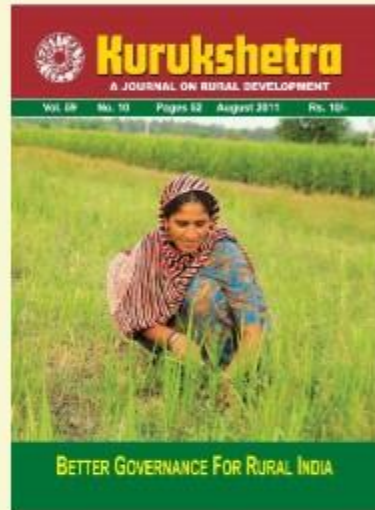


“CAN ALSO BE READ” BOOKS

- 1 Class IX NCERT textbook – Democratic Politics-I
- 2 Class X NCERT textbook – Democratic Politics-II
- 3 D.D.Basu Introduction to the Constitution of India or Subhash Kashyap's Our Parliament

INDIAN POLITY

SOURCES TO READ



SOURCES FOR CONTEMPORARY ISSUES (MOST IMPORTANT SECTION FOR MAINS GS II)

- 1 prsindia.org for bills/acts
- 2 Selective reading of **2nd ARC Report** for some of the topics like Local Governance, Citizen-Centric Administration, Ethics in Governance
- 3 **Yojana and Kurukshetra magazines** (will help you in framing good answers in mains. Also by reading the original magazine you will get good vocabulary skills and language proficiency which will help you to structure your Essay properly.)

2nd ARC

Ethics in Governance

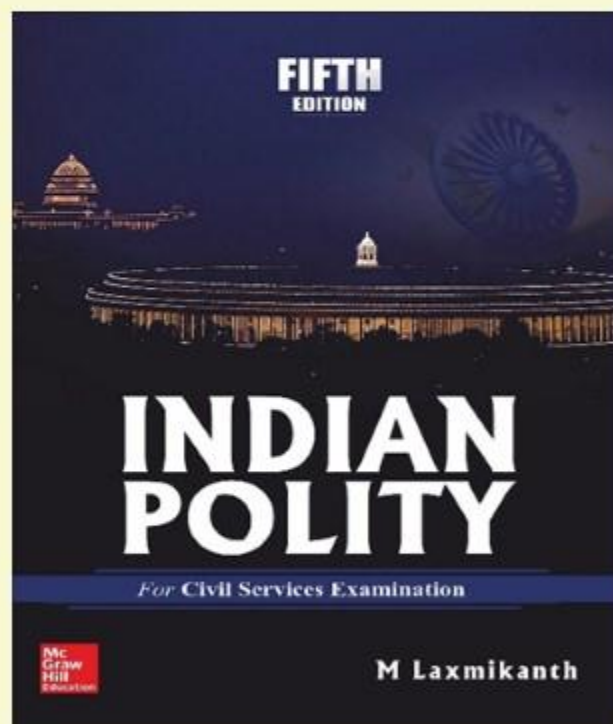
(4th Report)

**PRS Legislative
Research**



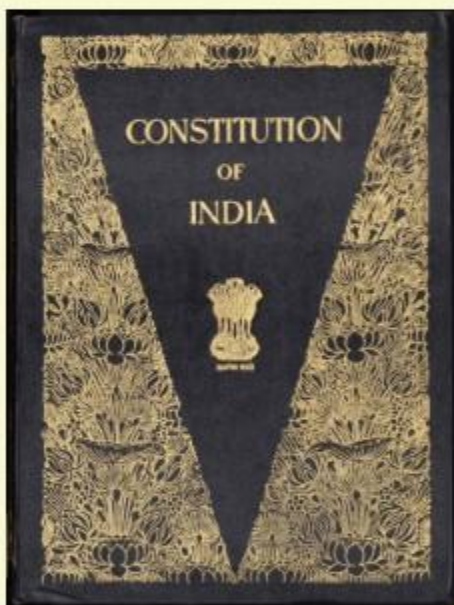
INDIAN POLITY

STRATEGY FOR PREPARATION



- 1** Start with the **NCERTs**. These are easy to read and gives good insights for beginners.
- 2** You can either start from the Class 9 book if you have a lot of time and then move on to class 10 and 11th standard books or you can straight away start with Class 11th book (Indian Constitution at Work)
- 3** The next logical step which can enhance one's preparation is to refer to Indian Polity by **M.Laxmikanth**. It happens to be the most resourceful and comprehensive book to prepare for Indian Polity for prelims. Almost all the topics mentioned in the syllabus are covered in this book. The language used in the book is lucid and even a beginner finds it easy to comprehend.

STRATEGY FOR PREPARATION



- 4** Introduction to the Constitution of India by D.D. Basu can be useful for mains and gives a candidate an in-depth analysis of the subject. However, beginners will find the language of this book quite complex.
- 5** Another important query among students is do we have to remember all the articles of Indian Constitution. Candidates need not mug up all the articles of the Indian Constitution. Only a few important articles are necessary. Most relevant articles would automatically get registered if one is clear with the basics and has revised the subject sufficient number of times.

STRATEGY FOR PREPARATION



NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS DISCUSSION

EDITORIAL DISCUSSION **LIVE**

WHAT DOES THIS MEAN?

- 1 Courts of a country before which a mediated settlement agreement is brought must ensure implementation of the terms of settlement.
- 2 When the settlement agreement comes up before the court, the court will review it on the basis of certain conditions.
- 3 These include the capacity of the parties to enter into the agreement, the question whether the subject matter of the agreement is one that can be settled through mediation in terms of its domestic laws and so on.
- 4 Once these issues are looked at, the court must enforce the agreement on the terms agreed.

Learning Space

- 6 It is vital to go through a **national daily like The Hindu or The Indian Express** and while reading these, pay special attention to news items and editorials that are either related to the Indian Constitution or the national as well as international political systems, in one way or the other.
- 7 All new bills, acts, policies and any related provisions should be noted down.(Use PRS for this)
- 8 Follow **Learning Space's Editorial Discussion and PIB articles** as GVR sir would discuss the past happenings of an issue and there will also be interlinking of various contemporary issues in one discussion.

STRATEGY FOR PREPARATION



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For example, the American and Indian Presidential election followed back to back so you must prepare for some questions pertaining to Presidential System in India.

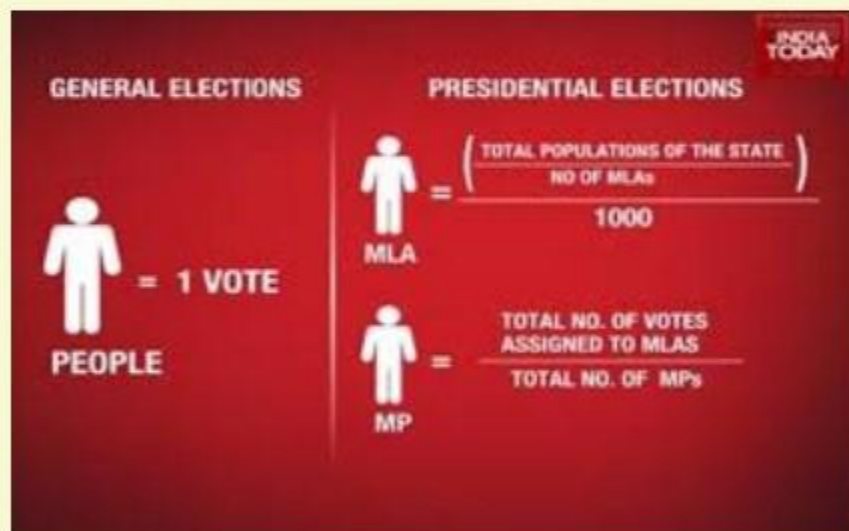
“Critically analyse the role of the President in a Parliamentary democracy. Do you think its time we change from Parliamentary system to Presidential system?”

STRATEGY FOR PREPARATION



- 6** Link every current political news with the articles mentioned in the book. Let's take another example: Like the recent issue of **Right to Privacy or Triple Talaq**. Try to understand which articles and values are at conflict like in the case of Right to Privacy. Understand the importance of imposing reasonable restrictions. Similarly, with case of Triple Talaq – the conflict between Right to equality (ARTICLE 14) and Freedom to manage the internal affairs of religion (ARTICLE 26). We could also think beyond that of how **Uniform Civil Code** (ARTICLE 44) becomes necessary and what would be the challenges.

STRATEGY FOR PREPARATION



Remember this question in this year's prelims?

7

Polity questions in prelims can get tricky, all options may look similar and this may lead to confusion and ambiguity.

8

Regular revisions and practicing MCQ's can help strengthen the basics and boost one's confidence in the subject. Solving previous year prelims question papers can aid a candidate in understanding the nature of questions and prepare accordingly.

HOW TO READ POLITY?

- 1** Indian Polity by Laxmikanth is the most comprehensive book for Polity.
- 2** In your first reading, just try to read the book and understand the basics of the book.
- 3** Read Part 1 to Part 4 ie from Constitutional Framework to State governments and avoid chapters like citizenship, Centre-State relationship for later reading.
- 4** Try to read chapter in part 3 (Central Government) and part 4 (State Government) in relation with each other as President chapter in part 3 should be followed by Governor chapter in part 4 and so on.
- 5** You will also find relationship in chapters in Part 7 and Part 8 (Constitutional and Non-Constitutional Bodies) .
- 6** Even during your first reading try to relate things coming in newspaper with the chapter you read in Laxmikanth.

HOW TO READ POLITY?

- 6** Start revising the chapter that u have already read and completing the remaining chapter in your subsequent reading.
- 7** Don't get disheartened if you forget some facts while doing your revision. It happens to all the students.
- 8** **Revise-Revise-Revise.** The best way to read Laxmikant is revising it as many times as possible.
- 9** **Solve Past Years Questions** so that you can see what type of questions are being asked in Polity. Most students neglect the PYQ part but its very important.
- 10** After giving one complete reading and two cycles of revision of the book, go through **our Polity MCQs discussion** and **try solving them on your own** without looking at the answers.
- 11** Practise and Revise and you will do wonders in Polity.

WE EXPRESS OUR SINCERE THANKS FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

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